



FOREST STEWARDSHIP STANDARDS PRE-APPROVAL ASSESSMENT REPORT:

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Name of Group that developed the standard:	Click or tap here to enter text.
Contact Person for the group:	Click or tap here to enter text.
Address:	Click or tap here to enter text.
Date:	Click or tap here to enter text.

Introduction

This report details all the elements to be evaluated by the Performance and Standards Unit (PSU) during the assessment of regional and national Forest Stewardship Standards. The suggestions for improvement made in this report are crucial to the approval of the FSC-STD-xxx-xx-xx

A checklist is attached to this report as an important part and therefore, feedback from Standards Development Groups (SDG) must be given with reference to the assessment made in the checklist.

The following terms are used to determine importance of a suggestion for improvement:

CONDITIONS- to be incorporated in the standard to the satisfaction of the FSC Performance Manager for National standard within specified timeframe indicated at the beginning of this document. Failure to incorporate suggestions within the specified timeframes may result in standard not being submitted on time to the Performance and Standards Committee for decision.

RECOMMENDATIONS- to be incorporated in the standard at the discretion of the registered Standard Development Group; Failure to incorporate recommendations does not affect the standard being submitted to the FSC Performance and Standards Committee for decision.

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SUMMARY OF ASSESSMENT

Reference	Condition for approval	Comments (PSU)
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SDG comments: Click or tap here to enter text.		

CONTENT OF REPORT

PART I. Process Assessment Summary

[Insert Text Here]

PART II: Content Assessment Summary

[Insert Text Here]

Checklists

Full Assessment of FSC Forest Stewardship Standards (FSS) setting Process for [Click or tap here to enter text.](#)

Requirements of FSC-STD-60-006 (V1-2) EN (V1-2) EN Process requirements for the development and maintenance of National Forest Stewardship Standards

Requirement	PSU Assessment of the Process	PSU Assessment – Additional Comments
1. Proposal		
1.1. Proposals to develop Forest Stewardship Standards (FSS) originated from discussion by the FSC Board of Directors, the FSC General Assembly, or from proposals by FSC members, FSC-accredited National Initiatives, members of FSC staff or staff of Accreditation Services International (ASI).	Choose an item.	
1.2. The formal decision to register development of FSS was taken by the Head of the FSC PSU, and took into account the approved strategic planning documentation, work plans and other instructions of the Executive Director.	Choose an item.	
1.3. All elements of the proposal (that is, the application for registration of the process) and Standard developed were submitted to FSC in either English or Spanish.	Choose an item.	
1.4. The development of the proposed FSC FSS did not proceed prior to the formal notification of registration from FSC PSU.	Choose an item.	
2. Official Announcement of a New Standard Under Development		
2.1. An announcement was sent to all key stakeholder groups within the territory once the process was officially registered by FSC PSU	Choose an item.	
3. Facilitation and Chairing		
3.1. The body which proposed the standards development (i.e. a body that has proposed the standard development, often an FSC National Office, or otherwise an SDG) shall identify the person (or positions) responsible for implementing each element identified in FSC-STD-60-006 (V1-2) EN	Choose an item.	
3.3. The person or position with facilitation and chairing responsibilities ensured that the SDG operated responsibly and in accordance with its ToR and the applicable procedures.	Choose an item.	

3.4. The person or position with facilitation and chairing responsibilities ensured that all members of the SDG have had the opportunity to express their opinions and concerns, and aimed to find consensus in all recommendations of the SDG.	Choose an item.
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3.5. The person or position with facilitation and chairing responsibilities ensured that there was effective communication with the appointed member of Staff within the FSC Performance and Standards Unit at all stages of development of the standard.	Choose an item.
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4. The Role of SDG During the Process

4.1 An SDG was established for the development of the Forest Stewardship Standards.	Choose an item.
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4.2 The SDG comprised three separate chambers representing social, environmental and economic interests, with at least two representatives in each chamber, and an equal number of people (or equal weighting) in each chamber.	Choose an item.
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4.3 Members of the SDG were selected on the basis of their: (a) expert knowledge and/or experience of the issue under consideration; (b) up-to-date knowledge and experience of FSC's systems and procedures; (c) representation of points of view from the corresponding FSC chamber, and the points of view of small, medium and large enterprises affected by the standard; (d) understanding of the potential impact of the standard on affected stakeholders; (e) understanding of and support for FSC's mission and vision; (f) ability to review and comment on documents submitted in the working language(s) established for the SDG	Choose an item.
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4.4. All members of the SDG received and committed to the ToR and work plan prior to commencement of the standards development.	Choose an item.
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4.5. Technical experts were appointed to participate in SDG discussions. These technical experts had voice in the SDG discussions, but no formal role in its decision-making processes.	Choose an item.
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4.6 When drafting the standard, the SDG:	Choose an item.
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- (a) took into account all relevant FSC documents pertaining to the process;
- (b) provided detailed input to the development of the FSS in accordance with its Terms of Reference;
- (c) signed off all drafts of the standard before they are submitted for consultation; and
- (d) formally recommended that the final draft standard be submitted to FSC for approval as an FSC FSS

4.7 The SDG was chaired by a person or persons appointed by consensus of the group. Choose an item.

4.8. The Chair(s) was independent from any one chamber and worked to broker consensus rather than represent the interests of any one chamber. Choose an item.

5. Terms of Reference and Work Plan

5.1. The SDG agreed to a Terms of Reference, the work plan and the budget for the development of the proposed standard. Choose an item.

5.2. The terms of reference for the SDG included at least the following: Choose an item.

- (a) the approved version of the proposal;
- (b) the procedures to be followed, including those required by this standard;
- (c) the agreed working language(s) for the Standards Development Group;
- (d) all documents related to the process of the development of FSC Forest Stewardship Standards;
- (e) any additional specific requirements to complete the work; and a
- (f) timetable for the standard development process.

5.3 The work plan included at least the following: Choose an item.

- (a) the setting up and support of the SDG;
- (b) the setting up and support of a Consultative Forum
- (c) drafting, consulting on, and redrafting standard(s);
- (d) the SDG shall test the standard in the forest prior to submission of a final draft to FSC for approval;
- (e) specification of a communications plan for the standard development process which shall establish the working language(s) for the standard's development and the most appropriate form of communication to stakeholder groups;
- (f) detailed timetable for the standard development process, including an estimated date on which the completed standard(s) will be submitted to FSC for the approval process.

5.4 The Terms of Reference, work plan and budget shall be signed off by the SDG and submitted to FSC PSU allowing two (2) weeks for comment prior to the commencement of the standards development.	Choose an item.
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6. Consultative Forum

6.1 The SDG was responsible for setting up a Consultative Forum for the standard's development process.	Choose an item.
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6.2 The Consultative Forum included, at a minimum, individuals and/or organizations who reflected the full range of stakeholders affected by the standard(s) under development at the national level.	Choose an item.
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6.3 The Consultative Forum was consulted and kept informed at each stage of the standards development process, and their comments were recorded and considered.	Choose an item.
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7. Preparatory Drafting and Consultation

7.1 A person (or position) was identified as responsible for compiling the standard on behalf of the SDG. These duties included record-keeping, minute-taking and circulation of papers to the Standards Development Group and Consultative Forum.	Choose an item.
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7.2 The role of the SDG members was to scrutinize and recommend drafts, review and advise on comments submitted by stakeholders, and suggest wording on specific aspects with the aim of achieving consensus support of all members of the Standards Development Group.	Choose an item.
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7.3 At a minimum, the following drafts were prepared: (a) a first draft, which was widely distributed to stakeholders for comment; (b) a second draft, which took into account the initial round of stakeholder comments and underwent forest-testing; (c) a 'forest-tested' draft, which took into account the results of forest testing, and which was widely distributed to stakeholders for comment; (d) a 'pre-approval' draft, which took into account additional stakeholder comments on the forest-tested draft	Choose an item.
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7.4 Drafts for public consultation were officially announced as identified in the communications plan	Choose an item.
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together with a summary of the key points and a formal comments form, and was circulated to:

- (a) all members of the Standards Development Group;
- (b) all members of the Consultative Forum;
- (c) all FSC National Initiatives and National and Regional Offices within the region;
- (d) all FSC-accredited certification bodies operating in the region; (e) all key stakeholder groups identified under Annex A; and, (f) the FSC Performance and Standards Unit.

7.5. The period to submit comments on the first draft for public consultation shall be a minimum of sixty (60) days from the date of publication. The period for consultation on intermediate drafts shall be a minimum of thirty (30) days from the date of publication. The period for consultation on the final draft prior to decision making shall be sixty (60) days from the date of publication.

Choose an item.

7.6 All formal comments shall be kept on file.

Choose an item.

7.7 A report on the formal comments shall be prepared which includes:

- (a) a summary of the issues raised;
- (b) an analysis of the range of stakeholder groups who have submitted comments;
- (c) a general response to the comments;
- (d) an indication of how the comments have been taken into account in the subsequent public draft standard; and
- (e) a copy of all the formal comments as an Annex.

Choose an item.

7.8 The SDG analyzed the sources of the comments to ensure that formal comments were received from representatives of all the key stakeholder groups which were identified as being impacted by the implementation of the proposed standard.

Choose an item.

7.9 The SDG demonstrated proactiveness in seeking input from representatives of stakeholder groups. Special provisions were made to ensure that formal comments were received from representatives of any marginalized groups that may be affected by the standard, and potential impacts of the standard on such groups were explicitly identified and taken into account in the development of the standard.

Choose an item.

8 Content: See content appraisal checklist below

9. Forest Testing

9.1 The new standard(s) was/were tested in the forest before submission to FSC for approval. Choose an item.

9.2 Ideally, the standard was tested in the range of conditions in which it is applicable, including both large and small forests, and in a representative range of forest types within the specified scope. Choose an item.

9.3 The standard was tested by an FSC-accredited certification body, and one representative of the SDG with technical expertise in forest management in the area of scope was also in attendance. Choose an item.

9.4 Testing included the full range of indicators included in the standard and considered the auditability of the standard as a whole, as well as the socioeconomic impacts of compliance. Choose an item.

9.5 A report on the results of the testing is made publicly available on request. Choose an item.

9.6 The findings from the forest testing were considered and agreed upon by the SDG. The resulting draft is known as the 'forest-tested' draft of the standard. Choose an item.

10. Draft Standard(s) Submitted for Decision-Making

10.1 Prior to the submission of the standard to FSC for approval, a formal motion was put before the SDG members stating that the draft standard:
(a) underwent sufficient consultation and testing;
(b) met the aims and objectives specified in the terms of reference of the SDG;
(c) merited the approval by FSC. Choose an item.

10.2. Once the draft standard had the formal recommendation of the SDG, it was published as identified in the communications plan. Choose an item.

10.3. A report was prepared on behalf of the SDG. The report:
(a) summarized the standards development process, taking into account any deviations from the original work plan;
(b) explained the main issues and concerns raised during the process, and explain how these have been addressed; Choose an item.

(c) included a clear description of any departures from these procedures, demonstrating compliance with the requirements of section 15 of FSC-STD-60-006 V1-2;

(d) included as Annexes a list of the names and affiliations of the members of the SDG, and the names and affiliations (including specification whether the stakeholder is an FSC member, and, if so, of which chamber and sub-chamber) of all stakeholders that submitted comments during the standards development process;

(e) included the motion of recommendation of the Standards Development Group, and the results of this motion;

(f) included a translation into English of the 'pre-approval' draft recommended for the approval of FSC; and

(g) included a copy of all formal comments received during the final period of public consultation.

10.4 The finalized report was sent to FSC PSU for formal approval.

Choose an item.

FSC Standards used for content assessment:	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN Structure and Content of National Forest Stewardship Standards
	FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN International Generic Indicators
	FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2 EN FSC Principles and Criteria for Forest Stewardship

Requirements	Evaluation/ Comment	Feedback to SDG
Structure of FSS		
Document code for FSS is appropriately assigned	Requirement to be fulfilled by FSC PSU	None expected
FSS include an Introduction	Choose an item.	None expected
FSS introduction has no doubtful statement	Choose an item.	None expected
Specification of Scope		
FSS clearly specifies the geographical, ecological, and political scope to which it applies	Choose an item.	
FSS includes a Preamble/Preface	Choose an item.	
FSS includes FSC Normative reference documents relevant for the implementation of the standard	Choose an item.	
FSS include a space for PSU to insert Effective Date	Choose an item.	
FSS include a Table of Contents	Choose an item.	
FSC Hierarchical Framework: NFSS are structured in the order: Principle -Criterion-Indicator-verifier-Guidance (where needed)	Choose an item.	
Numbering in FSS is consistent	Choose an item.	
The numbering of Principles and Criteria within the standard shall be the same as in FSC-STD-01-001 FSC Principles and Criteria of Forest Stewardship.	Choose an item.	
Indicators shall be numbered with the initial numbers of the relevant FSC Criterion, followed by numbering for each indicator within the criterion.	Choose an item.	

Content of NFSS	
NFSS includes wordings of FSC P&C as originally approved.	Choose an item.
FSS includes justified additional Criteria	Choose an item.
FSS include a justification for considering an FSC criterion not applicable	Choose an item.
FSS complies with all latest versions of approved FSC normative frameworks	Choose an item.
FSS shall not state that only those conventions to which the country is a signatory are to be respected	Choose an item.
FSS includes definitions to identify any categories of users to whom special provisions are applicable.	Choose an item.
Where the NFSS include guidance or applicability notes, it is clearly stated that these notes are not normative	Choose an item.
Development of Indicators:	
FSC-STD-60-002 V1-0 EN was used as the starting point for the development of the NFSS	Choose an item.
Each indicator specifies one aspect of compliance.	Choose an item.
When an FSC Criterion includes several requirements, associated indicators shall be developed for each requirement.	Choose an item.
Each indicator refers to a single aspect of performance to be evaluated: (Note: an indicator which includes more than one aspect to be evaluated shall list these aspects separately as sub-divisions of the indicator)	Choose an item.
Indicators specify outcomes or levels (i.e., thresholds) of performance that are measurable during an evaluation at a reasonable cost. The level of performance required to comply with the indicators should be clear to the reader.	Choose an item.
Indicators are not defined in terms of design or descriptive characteristics, and do not favour a particular technology or patented item.	Choose an item.
Indicators only include elements that contribute to the achievement of the	Choose an item.

objective of the applicable FSC Criterion.	
Indicators are written using a clear and consistent vocabulary, free from subjective elements.	Choose an item.
Every indicator should include examples of means of verification.	Choose an item.

Assessing the use of IGIs in NFSS

Please refer to the FSC Transfer matrix that was used during the process of developing the Australian NFSS, for more information on how to improve requirements in the standard.

Please provide an indication of how many IGIs have been:

Adopted:		FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected
Adapted:		FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected
Dropped:	See Transfer Matrix for details (summary sheet)	FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected
New Indicators Added:		FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected
Total IGIs:		FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected
Total Indicators in the Metropolitan France NFSS:		FSC-STD-60-004 V1-0 EN	None expected

Scale Intensity and Risk in NFSS (Content)

NFSS address Scale Intensity and Risks at least for those P&C where this is explicitly stated	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected
The standard shall include clear guidance as to the category of forest management units to which any exemptions or alternative indicators apply.	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected

Annexes of NFSS

At least the following Annexes are provided in the NFSS:

A) a list of the national and local forest laws and administrative requirements which apply in the country or region in which the standard is to be used,	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected
B) A list of the multilateral environmental agreements and conventions that the country has ratified and the ILO Conventions listed in FSC-POL-30-401 FSC and the ILO Conventions which must be complied with in all FSC certified forests,	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected
C) A list of, or reference to official lists of, endangered species in the country or region in which the standard is to be used.	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected
NFSS has HCV interpretations or a tool for HCV assessment is annexed to the NFSS	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected
NFSS include FSC Glossary of terms at it Annex	Choose an item.	FSC-STD-60-002 (V1-0) EN	None expected



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